

Operation Handwriting, Materials

Everything here is also built into the printable PDFs in `materials/pdf/`. This file is the text source so a teacher can adapt a word, a sentence or a passage without touching the PDF generator. Print list per group is in section 5 of the plan.

1. Printable pack (materials/pdf)

File	For	Contents
lined-paper-cycle1.pdf	C1 and weakest students of C2, C3	Three-line paper, 19 mm rows, dashed midline
lined-paper-cycle2.pdf	C2	Three-line paper, 13 mm rows, dashed midline
lined-paper-cycle3.pdf	C3	Single lines, 9 mm, left margin
pretest-posttest.pdf	All	Test sheet, English and French versions, one line type per cycle
c1-print-letters.pdf	C1, Days 2 to 6	Pattern sheet, print lowercase sheets A to E by family, capitals, numbers, size sort
c1-spacing-sentences.pdf	C1, Days 7 to 9	Spacing sheet, sentence sheets, dictation record
c2-cursive-letters.pdf	C2, Days 3 to 8	Cursive lowercase sheets A to E by family, joins sheet, cursive capitals
c2-c3-size-spacing-slant.pdf	C2 Day 2, C3 Days 2 to 4	Self-check sheet, size and spacing sheet, slant sheet, spacing sheet
c3-fluency.pdf	C3, Days 5 to 9	Joins repair, speed sheet, dictation sheet, presentation sheet
teacher-pack.pdf	Teachers	Rubric, class tracking sheet, daily checklist, warm-up card, posture and grip poster
student-pack.pdf	All students	Progress chart, folder cover, certificate

Regenerate everything with `python3 tools/build_pdfs.py` from the `operation-handwriting` folder.

2. Test passages (Day 1 and Day 10, identical)

English: The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog. I write with care and I sit up tall. Every letter sits on the line and every word has its space.

French: Le petit chat gris joue avec la balle jaune dans le jardin. J'écris avec soin et je me tiens bien droit. Chaque lettre est sur la ligne et chaque mot a sa place.

Free writing prompt (Cycles 2 and 3, 5 minutes after the copy): "Write three sentences about something you did this week." / "Écris trois phrases sur quelque chose que tu as fait cette semaine."

Time limits: Cycle 1, 10 minutes for the copy, no free writing. Cycles 2 and 3, 8 minutes for the copy, 5 minutes free writing. The rubric is applied to the copy. The free writing is kept in the folder for the Day 10 comparison.

3. Scoring rubric (six criteria, 1 to 4 each, 24 points)

Criterion	1	2	3	4
Letter formation	Many letters malformed or reversed, drawn in pieces	Several letters malformed, some reversals	Most letters correct, a few inconsistencies	All letters formed correctly and the same way each time
Size and proportion	No difference between tall, small and tail letters	Sizes inconsistent, some distinction	Sizes mostly correct, occasional slips	Tall, small and tail letters clearly and consistently sized
Baseline	Letters float or sink throughout	Frequent floating or sinking	Mostly on the line	Every letter sits on the line
Spacing	Words run together or gaps are random	Spacing uneven, some words touch	Mostly even, a few tight or wide gaps	Even letter spacing, clear word spaces
Slant and consistency	Slant changes letter by letter	Slant varies within words	Mostly consistent	One consistent slant throughout
Legibility	A stranger cannot read most of it	Readable with effort	Readable with occasional hesitation	Readable at first glance

Score bands: 6 to 11 needs intervention, 12 to 17 developing, 18 to 21 secure, 22 to 24 excellent.

4. Word banks by letter family (English / French)

The worksheets carry one English and one French word per letter. Teachers can swap them for these or their own.

Straight line family: l, leaf / lune. i, ink / île. t, top / tasse. Round family: c, cat / carte. o, open / orage. a, apple / arbre. d, door / dent. g, goat / gare. q, queen / quatre. Bump family: r, rain / rue. n, nest / nuit. m, moon / main. h, hat / haut. b, book / bleu. p, pen / porte. Tricky family: e, egg / école. s, sun / sac. f, fish / fleur. k, kite / kiwi. u, up / usine. v, van / vent. w, water / wagon. x, box / taxi. y, yes / yeux. z, zip / zéro. j, jam / jour.

Cursive undercurve family: i, it / ici. u, up / une. w, we / wapiti. t, to / tu. Cursive loop family: e, eat / elle. l, lit / lit. h, hut / huit. k, kit / kaki. b, bet / bal. f, fit / fil. Cursive round family: a, at / ami. d, did / dur. g, get / gel. q, quit / qui. c, cat / cou. o, on / os. Cursive overcurve family: n, net / nez. m, mat / mur. v, vet / vie. x, ax / axe. y, yet / yoga. z, zig / zone. Cursive remaining: r, rat / riz. s, sit / sel. p, pit / pas. j, jet / joli.

Join practice pairs: ll, ee, nn, in, at, up, an, it, ov, wi, bo, wa, ve, br, os, ws. Join practice words: little, bottle, window, brown, always, house / petite, bouteille, fenêtre, brun, toujours, maison.

5. Sentences

Cycle 1, Day 8 copying (English then French): I sit up tall. / Je suis assis bien droit. My pencil is sharp. / Mon crayon est pointu. We help our friends. / Nous aidons nos amis. The sun is hot today. / Il fait chaud aujourd'hui. I love my school. / J'aime mon école. Honesty is the best. / L'honnêteté est la meilleure.

Cycle 1, Day 9 dictation (teacher reads each sentence twice, slowly): The cat sat on the mat. / Le chat est sur le tapis. I can run and jump. / Je peux courir et sauter. We read a good book. / Nous lisons un bon livre. My hat is red and blue. / Mon chapeau est rouge et bleu. The bus is big. / L'autobus est grand. I am kind to all. / Je suis gentil avec tous.

Cycle 2, Day 9 paragraph (copy in cursive): English: Good handwriting is a gift to the reader. When my letters are clear, my ideas are clear too. I take my time, I sit up straight, and I make every letter sit on the line. French: Une belle écriture est un cadeau pour le lecteur. Quand mes lettres sont claires, mes idées le sont aussi. Je prends mon temps, je me tiens droit, et chaque lettre est sur la ligne.

Cycle 2, Day 9 dictation: The little bird sat on the window. / Le petit oiseau est sur la fenêtre. We always help at home. / Nous aidons toujours à la maison. My brown bag is on the table. / Mon sac brun est sur la table. The house has a blue door. / La maison a une porte bleue.

Cycle 3, Day 7 speed passage (copy for one minute, three minutes, five minutes, count legible words per minute): English: The best writers are not the fastest. They are the ones whose words can be read by anyone, at any time, without asking what a letter was meant to be. Speed comes on its own once the hand knows every letter by heart. Until then, we write clearly, we keep the same slant, and we leave a space the size of a letter between words. A page that can be read is a page that respects the person reading it. French: Les meilleurs scripteurs ne sont pas les plus rapides. Ce sont ceux dont les mots peuvent être lus par n'importe qui, à tout moment, sans demander ce qu'une lettre voulait dire. La vitesse vient d'elle-même quand la main connaît chaque lettre par cœur. D'ici là, nous écrivons clairement, nous gardons la même inclinaison, et nous laissons un espace de la taille d'une lettre entre les mots. Une page lisible est une page qui respecte la personne qui la lit.

Cycle 3, Day 8 dictation (read at normal speaking pace, one pass, then students clean up): Use the Day 7 passage. Reading it once at speaking pace takes about 45 seconds. Read it twice with a pause between.

Cycle 3, Day 9 presentation paragraph (final copy with title, date, margin, indent): Title: Why I write clearly / Pourquoi j'écris clairement Students write their own paragraph of 5 to 7 sentences. Draft first on the presentation sheet's rough side, then a final copy on the clean side.

6. Warm-up card (5 minutes, read to the group)

Shoulders: roll them back five times, forward five times. Wrists: circle ten times each way, then shake the hands out. Fingers: squeeze a fist tight, open wide, ten times. Then touch each finger to the thumb, forward and back, three rounds. Pencil walk: hold the pencil at the tip, walk the fingers up to the top and back down without the other hand. Air letters: teacher calls three letters from yesterday, students write them in the air with a straight arm, big and slow, saying the pathway. Posture call: "feet, back, arms, paper, helper hand". Wait until everyone is set.

7. Posture and grip poster (text for the wall)

Feet flat on the floor. Back against the chair. Both arms on the desk. Paper tilted, top to the right if you write with your right hand, top to the left if you write with your left hand. Helper hand holds the paper still. Pencil rests on the middle finger, held by the thumb and the index finger, two fingers from the tip. Fingers bent and relaxed, no white knuckles. Light grey line, no grooves on the back of the page.

8. Progress chart

Ten boxes, one per day, the student colours the box at the end of the hour. Under each box the teacher's wish for tomorrow in two or three words. At the bottom: pre-test score, post-test score, gain.

9. Staff launch message (WhatsApp, principal to staff group)

As Salam Alaykum

Operation Handwriting

It has come to my attention, and I am sure you have all noticed it too, that the handwriting across the school is well below where it should be. Pages that cannot be read do not reflect the effort behind them, and this is something we fix now rather than later.

Starting Monday, September 21st and for two weeks until Friday, October 2nd, every cycle will have one hour

every day dedicated to handwriting. This is in addition to the regular program and the hour does not get shortened or split.

1. Groups are by cycle. Cycle 1, Cycle 2 and Cycle 3 each have a lead teacher who runs the daily hour, scores the pre-test on Day 1 and the post-test on Day 10 and keeps the tracking sheet. I will confirm the lead teacher for each cycle by tonight.
2. The plan, the teacher's guide and all the printable material are in the shared folder. Please read the teacher's guide before Monday, it takes 20 minutes. Everything needed each day is in the plan.
3. Every teacher in every subject is part of this. *During these two weeks, any written work that is not legible is handed back to be rewritten, in every class.* This is what makes it stick.
4. Assistants join the guided practice block each day to work with the five weakest students of each group at a separate table.
5. On Day 10 each lead teacher sends me the tracking sheet with the pre-test and post-test scores and the names of students still below 12. I will do a walk-through of every group on Day 1, Day 5 and Day 10.

Please confirm that you have read the guide by Sunday night.

I know this is an added load on an already full schedule. It is two weeks, and the students will carry the benefit for years. May Allah reward you for your efforts.

Jazakallah khayra

10. Parent note (WhatsApp, sent Day 2)

As Salam Alaykum

Just a note to let you know that from Monday, September 21st to Friday, October 2nd the school is running a two-week handwriting program. Every student has one hour of handwriting practice each day with their cycle. Your child will bring home a folder with their work at the end of the two weeks, including a sample from the first day and the last day.

Nothing is required at home. If you would like to help, five minutes of copying a sentence in their best writing, sitting up straight with the paper tilted, is enough. Please do not correct the letters yourselves, the teachers are working on one thing at a time with each child.

Petit mot pour vous informer que du lundi 21 septembre au vendredi 2 octobre, l'école mène un programme d'écriture de deux semaines. Chaque élève a une heure de pratique d'écriture par jour avec son cycle. Votre enfant rapportera à la maison un dossier avec ses travaux à la fin des deux semaines, y compris un échantillon du premier jour et du dernier jour.

Rien n'est exigé à la maison. Si vous souhaitez aider, cinq minutes de copie d'une phrase dans sa plus belle écriture, bien assis avec la feuille inclinée, suffisent. Veuillez ne pas corriger les lettres vous-mêmes, les enseignants travaillent sur un point à la fois avec chaque enfant.